[METRIC]

A-A-3078
December 16, 1996

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF, SECTIONAL-POST-TYPE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in lieu of Federal specification UU-B-336, which is canceled.

1. Scope. This document covers binders of the sectional-post type, for general office use.

2. Classification. The binders shall be of the following types and classes, as specified.

Type I - Top locking mechanism
Type II - End locking mechanism

Class 1 - Cloth hinges
Class 2 - Metal hinges

3. Salient characteristics.

3.1. Dimensions. Dimensions shall be as specified (see 8.2) with first dimension as binding edge.

3.2. Construction. The binders shall consist essentially of two covers held together by means of two sectional posts and a locking mechanism (see 3.2.1). The outside dimensions of the binder shall be sufficiently larger than the "Sheet size", to protect filler sheets and index tabs contained in the binders.

3.2.1. Post Assembly. The post assembly shall consist of a metal housing hinged to each cover. The lower housing shall be fitted with threaded base sockets into which post sections shall be screwed. The upper housing shall hold the locking mechanism.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document, should be sent to: General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, 26 Federal Plaza, New York N.Y. 10278 ATTN: Engineering Branch (2FYEE).

FSC 7510

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3.2.1.1. Housings. The lower housing shall be a continuous metal tube or a continuous flat metal plate. If of the tube type, the lower housing shall be made of steel not less than 0.89 mm (0.035)" thick. The ends of housing tubes shall be capped with aluminum, steel, plastic, or rubber end plugs. If of the plate type, the lower housing shall be of steel having a cross section of not less than 1.59 x 22.23 mm (0.0625 x 0.875)" or 16-gauge strip steel. The plate shall be backed by two sheets of not less than 3.0 mm (0.120)" thick book cover board, securely glued together and to the housing plate. The upper housing shall be a continuous metal tube similar to the lower housing, fitted with either a top-locking mechanism as specified in 3.2.1.1.1., or an end-locking mechanism as specified in 3.2.1.1.2., capable of holding the housing firmly at any desired position on the posts. Locking mechanisms shall operate smoothly and efficiently.

3.2.1.1.1. Type I binders. The top-locking mechanism for Type I binders shall be operated by either a knurled thumb knob or slide button on top of the housing.

3.2.1.1.2. Type II binders. The end-locking mechanism for Type II binders shall be located at one end of the housing and shall be operated by means of a winged clock key (see 3.2.1.1.2.1). The locking device shall be constructed of cold-rolled steel. All surfaces of the locking device shall be casehardened.

3.2.1.1.2.1. Key. One winged clock key shall be furnished with each Type II binder and secured to binder for safekeeping in shipment in accordance with normal commercial practice.

3.2.1.2. Posts. The center-to-center location and the diameter of the posts shall be as specified (See 8.3). Posts shall be made of steel having a hardness of not less than 65 Rockwell B scale. Unless otherwise specified, each post equipment furnished with binders shall consist of two 1.3 cm (1/2)" sections, one 2.5 cm (1)" section, and one 1.3 cm (1/2)" smooth top section. Posts shall be placed equidistant from edges of binder within 0.32 cm (1/8)" tolerance.

3.3. Materials. Materials shall be as specified hereinafter.

3.3.1. Covers. Each cover shall be made from book cover board conforming to UU-B-623, and having an average thickness of not less than 5.58 mm (0.220)" and a minimum bursting strength of 5500 kPascals (800 psi). Corners of covers at the index edge shall be rounded.

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3.3.2. Binding materials. Covers and post housing shall be bound with a continuous piece of Army duck having two-ply yarns (two single yarns twisted together) in both the warp and the filling directions, or of latex fiber made from new cotton rag fibers impregnated with latex. The Army duck and latex fiber material shall each weigh not less than 237 g/m^2 (7 oz/square yard), and shall be slate-gray, slate-blue, green, or brown in color, as specified. The binding material shall be carried over the post housing and over the inside face of covers at least 1.59cm (5/8)" beyond the edges. The binding material shall be securely glued in place.

3.3.2.1. Army duck.

3.3.2.1.1. Colorfastness to crocking shall have a rating of at least "fair", when tested in accordance with applicable commercial method.

3.3.2.1.2. Breaking strength. The Army duck shall have a breaking strength of 13.8 Newtons (100 lbs) warp and 8.3 Newtons (60 lbs) filling, ± 5%, when tested with applicable commercial method.

3.3.2.2. Latex fiber.

3.3.2.2.1. Colorfastness. The latex fiber shall not show any appreciable change in color. The latex fiber shall be wet thoroughly with water and then completely dried. After drying, the test sample shall be inspected for any appreciable change in color.

3.3.2.2.2. Tearing and breaking strength. The latex fiber shall not tear or break when subjected to a breaking force of approximately 3.5 Newtons (25 lbs). The sample shall be tested in both a wet and a dry condition.

3.3.2.2.3. Flexure. The latex fiber sample shall be flexed 8,000 to 10,000 times without failure. The sample shall be flexed through a minimum bend radius of 135 degrees. The latex fiber shall show no undue wear.

3.3.2.2.4. Moisture. The latex fiber shall not tear or show other adverse effects. The latex fiber sample shall be thoroughly soaked in water and subjected to the test specified in 3.3.2.2.2. above.

3.3.2.2.5. Abrasion. The latex fiber shall not show any evidence of excessive wear. The latex fiber sample shall be subjected to continuous cycles of abrasion for approximately 5 min. The abrasive material shall be a medium grade of sandpaper.

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3.3.3. Lining. Lining for the inside face of covers shall be a suitable paper having a minimum weight of 97.6 grams/m^2 (60 lbs,24" x 36" - 500 sheets), securely glued to the cover.

3.3.4. Metal parts. Unless otherwise specified, all exposed metal parts shall be zinc-coated or shall be given a black oxide finish covered overall with a suitable drying oil or shall be otherwise treated to resist corrosion.

3.3.5. Hinge. The hinge shall connect the binding post housing to the cover.

3.3.5.1. Class 1. Class 1 hinges shall consist of three thicknesses of binding material securely glued together.

3.3.5.2. Class 2. Class 2 hinges shall be of the continuous piano type made of cold-rolled steel.

3.5. Index-tab allowance. Binders shall have an index-tab allowance of 2.22 ± 0.16 cm (7/8 ± 1/16)".

3.6. Marking. Each binder shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark. In addition, the following information shall be legibly printed or stamped on the inside of one cover of each binder:

"PROPERTY OF THE U.S. GOVERNMENT"

3.7. Workmanship. Binders shall be well finished. All edges and surfaces shall be smooth and securely fastened. Binders shall be free from any defects which may effect the appearance and impair serviceability.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS:

Certification (paperboard). The contractor shall certify that the paperboard used in the manufacture of this item contains a minimum of 80% Post Consumer Recovered Material (PCRM) in accordance with Code 40 of the Federal Regulations Part 247, Comprehensive Guideline for Procurement of Products Containing Recovered Materials; Final Rule. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery, and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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5. QUALITY ASSURANCE:

5.1 Product conformance. The product provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, conform to producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

6. PACKAGING, PACKING AND MARKING: Packing, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

7. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS: The issues of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

7.1. Title 40, Code of Federal Regulations, Protection of the Environment, Part 247. Copies may be purchased with a VISA, Master Card or prepaid check through: Government Printing Office, Washington, DC; Phone 202-783-3238. When ordering ask for: Title 40, Parts 190-250; Stock Number: 869-013-00-146-0.

7.2. Federal Standards, Specifications and Commercial Item Descriptions, may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at 490 L'Enfant Plaza, SW Washington D.C.20407. phone numbers(202) 708-9205, or FTS-458-9205.

8. ORDERING DATA. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in the procurement documents:

8.1. Type and class of binder required.
8.2. Dimension of the binder required.
8.3. Center-to-center post distance & post diameter required.
8.4. Packaging, packing and marking required.

MILITARY INTEREST:

ARMY - GL

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

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